

Where I Can Study Spanish in Spain

The universities that give you a **Route 1** student permit — the one with automatic work rights.

What Route 1 gives you

- **30 hours a week of work, automatically.** No separate application, no employer paperwork.
- **A permit as long as your course** — no one-year cap.
- **Two extensions**, not one.
- **You can apply for your master's from inside Spain** — no flying home.
- **You can convert to a work permit** after the master's, under Article 190.

HOW A COURSE GETS YOU ROUTE 1

1. It is taught **face to face** — not online.
2. It is taught by a **university**.
3. The language is not your own. Tunisia's official language is Arabic, so **you pass**.

A private language school — don Quijote, Enforex and the rest — is **Route 2**, whatever its website says. No automatic work rights, one extension, and no work permit at the end.

TWO THINGS EVERY COURSE MUST HAVE

At least 91 days. Below that there is no permit at all.

More than six months, if you want a TIE card and a real residence. Below six months you get a visa sticker and you go home.

The universities you can apply to

Full-time courses — 15 to 25 hours a week, at least 91 days, open to you as a paying student from Tunisia. Thirteen of them.

UNIVERSITY	CITY	PRICE	H/WK	JANUARY 2027
IELE — Extremadura ★	Cáceres	2.500 11 months	20	18 Jan → 18 Dec
CELE — Zaragoza	Zaragoza	2.230 770 hours	20	11 Jan → 19 May
Centro de Idiomas — León	León	3.600 720h, 60 ECTS	20	7 Jan → 21 Dec
Servicio de Idiomas — Murcia	Murcia	1.575 300 hours	~18	— Feb to May
Casa de las Lenguas — Oviedo	Oviedo	1.625 one semester	—	11 Jan → 14 May
Centro de Lenguas — Almería	Almería · coast	2.700 600 hours	20	— October start
Cursos de Español — La Rioja	Logroño	2.725 390 hours	20	11 Jan → 16 Jun
Cursos Intl. — Santiago	Santiago	2.691 +230 deposit	20	7 Jan — beginners only
Centro Intl. del Español — Burgos	Burgos	3.000 620 hours	—	— August start
CIE — Málaga	Málaga · coast	800 per month	20	8–29 Jan, monthly
CSIdiomas — Alicante	Alicante · coast	4.500–6.665	15–25	7 Jan → 17 Dec
CCEE — Complutense	Madrid	5.550 600 hours	25	8 Jan → 28 Jul
Idiomes UAB	Barcelona	236 per week	20	monthly starts

THREE MORE YOU COULD APPLY TO – WITH A PROBLEM EACH

Granada CLM — €4,199 to €6,058. But: **no refund if your visa is refused.** The only centre in Spain with that clause.

Alcalingua, Alcalá — €5,310, but no January entry.

UB Barcelona — €6,444 for a course explicitly named "*para visado*", but its January option is only 94 days.

Cheaper, but part-time

These are Route 1 too, and the low hours do not make them illegal. But three to five hours a week is hard to show a consulate as full-time study.

UNIVERSITY	CITY	PRICE	H/WK
Servicio de Idiomas — Cartagena	Cartagena · coast	125	2,5
Servicio de Lenguas — Huelva	Huelva · coast	190	3
Institut de Llengües — Lleida	Lleida	208–292	4–6
Servicio de Idiomas — UAM	Madrid	250 (70 contact hours a year)	3
Servicio de Idiomas — La Laguna	Tenerife · coast	250	3
CEALM — Jaén	Jaén	300	4
CIUC — Cantabria	Santander · coast	332	5
Centre d'Idiomes — València	Valencia · coast	408	4
Instituto de Idiomas — Sevilla	Sevilla	425	3
Centro de Lenguas UPV	Valencia · coast	450	4
Instituto de Lenguas — UCV	Valencia · coast	525	4
Centro de Lenguas — Vigo	Vigo · coast	570	4
CUI — Pablo de Olavide	Sevilla	2.655 / semester	–
UCOIdiomas — Córdoba	Córdoba	5.088 / 600h	–
ESTO — Toledo	Toledo	7.355 all in	20
Centro de Lenguas — UPM	Madrid	not published	4

Universities you cannot use

UNIVERSITY	WHY NOT
Salamanca	Longest course is 68 days — below the 91-day minimum
UPV/EHU Bilbao	Courses are closed to anyone outside the university
UIMP Santander	Summer only, maximum four weeks
Las Palmas	Spanish is online only — fails the face-to-face rule
Girona and Ramon Llull	They teach no Spanish at all
UIB Palma · Jaume I · Cádiz · A Coruña	No course reaches 91 days
Idiomes UPF Barcelona	The long course is sold only through an agency in China
Tarragona · Centro Intl. Sevilla	No price published anywhere
Comillas · CEU · URJC · Europea de Madrid	Nothing published, or no centre exists

What I would do

Cáceres — IELE — €2,500 — January 2027

Of sixty Spanish universities with a language centre, **it is the only one selling a full academic year that starts in January.** Everything else with a January date gives you four to seven months.

It is also the **cheapest city in Spain** to live in — about €535 a month — and the regional government runs public halls at **€425 to €460 a month with all meals included.**

And if your visa is refused you get everything back except €150. If it is merely slow, you move to a later intake for free.

Then the master's

Andalucía charges non-EU students **no extra fee.** Madrid charges nearly double.

MASTER'S	WHERE	COST FOR YOU
Ingeniería del Software e Inteligencia Artificial — taught in Spanish and English	Málaga	820,80
Ciencia de Datos e Ingeniería de Computadores	Granada	820,80
Ingeniería Informática	León	1.572
Ingeniería Informática	Extremadura	3.366,90
Ingeniería Informática	Complutense, Madrid	7.566,30

THE CHEAPEST WHOLE PATH IN SPAIN

Language year in Cáceres €2,500 — then the software master's in Málaga €820.80. €3,320 of tuition for both, and the master's matches your degree.

Three emails, this week, costing nothing

TO	ASK
seciele@unex.es IELE Cáceres	Is the January start the 11th or the 18th ? Their own pages disagree. And will the enrolment certificate show the whole period, total hours and weekly hours ?
idiomas@unileon.es León	Can all three trimesters be one enrolment , January to December 2027?
inmigracion@aragon.es SAOJI Zaragoza	Free consultation with a real lawyer, run by the regional government and the bar. Ask which article your course falls under.

ONE THING TO CHECK WHEN YOU ARRIVE

Your TIE card will tell you which permit you actually got. If it prints "**NO AUTORIZA A TRABAJAR**", you were given the weaker one — and you can fix it from inside Spain, without going back to Tunis.